

Ben had a sinking feeling inside, as if something was dying. And in truth he knew that something was: their marriage.

“Look, Naomi, I’m sorry for what I said last night. I didn’t mean it. I don’t want us to have separate checking accounts and split the expenses.”

“No, you just want to be able to spend what you want, when you want,” Naomi fired back. “Well, no more. You pay your part, and I’ll pay my part from now on. And if you don’t like it, I’ll take Timmy and leave.”

“Do you really mean that?” Ben asked, hurt.

“I really do,” she replied defiantly. “I don’t even know if I love you anymore, but I do know that I don’t respect you. I’ve been on the giving end of our marriage from the first day. From now on I’m going to do what’s best for me.”

Ben felt as if someone had just hit him in the stomach with a sledgehammer. *How did everything go wrong?* he thought as Naomi flounced out of the dining room. *How could I have been stupid enough to let our relationship disintegrate? I don’t know what to do now.* For the first time in a long time Ben fell to his knees and asked God to forgive him and help him to heal his marriage.



Ben and Naomi represent many couples today, Christian and nonChristian alike. They enter marriage with little or no understanding of finances and quickly find themselves overwhelmed by the opportunities they encounter to spend more than they make. Since opposites do attract, usually one partner is an optimist, who generally looks toward the future to straighten out any errors in the present. The other, a worrier, needs stability and security.

Optimists don’t purposely lie to their spouses. They convince themselves that things will change for the better. Ben was an optimist. Naomi, the worrier, became suspicious of Ben because of what appeared to be deceptions and financial irresponsibility. She